Helix Thready — Design & UX Area (Index)

Rev	Date	Author	Change
1	2026-07-21	swarm (design)	Initial complete draft: design system, brand assets, theming, wireframes, UX flows, component library, prototypes
2	2026-07-21	swarm (design · review)	Second-pass review: fixed cross-link anchors (numbered to match target ToCs), noted `account_branding` reconciliation with canonical `accounts.branding` JSONB, tracked `challenges` scenario bank + delegated-branding open items
3	2026-07-22	swarm (design · Pass 3)	Depth pass to implementation-ready: re-verified all `design_system` token/component/adapter names at source (`gh vasic-digital/design_system`); deepened wireframes (per-screen validation/state tables, CLI flags/exit-codes, **verified** TUI keymap + Lipgloss bindings from `helix_track/llms_verifier/.../tui` , per-platform mobile map); expanded UX flows (+messenger sign-in, +reprocess diagrams); completed component per-platform variant matrix + 6 more contracts + state-lifecycle diagram; finalized brand-assets geometry + concrete platform manifests + slogan-placement matrix; added shipped-theme precedents. 4 new diagrams.
4	2026-07-22	swarm (design · critic pass)	Completeness/consistency pass: made the index the **canonical registry** — completed the Open items list (was 4 of 14; now all `THREADY-DES-01…-14`) and added the Workable-items registry (was scattered across files; now consolidated with

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			owning gap + file). Brought `prototypes.md` to area depth (Pass 3): corrected the **unverified "first-party Figma plugin"** claim to an assumption + source-confirmed Figma-Variables fallback; added the interactive-prototype traceability matrix + prototype runtime-evidence gate.

This is the canonical entry point for the **Design & UX** documentation of Helix Thready. It specifies the design system (derived from **OpenDesign** and the shared in-house `vasic-digital/design_system`), the **Thready** brand theme derived from `assets/Logo.png`, the launcher-icon and slogan brand assets, per-account theming / white-labeling, wireframes for every client surface, the key UX journeys, the reusable component library, and the interactive / non-interactive prototype plans. All authors follow **../CONVENTIONS.md**.

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Scope

The Design & UX area covers, per the operator request (§Design, §Frontends, §Branding) and the decision matrix `[CONSTITUTION §11.4.162/190]`:

1. The **design system** derived from OpenDesign (`nexu-io/open-design`) and the shared `vasic-digital/design_system` (helix-green base), with a Thready theme derived from `Logo.png`, **light + dark**, and per-platform variants (Angular/CSS, React, KMP/Compose, Flutter/Qt, TUI/Lipgloss).
2. The **brand assets** spec — a launcher icon with **no letters** that incorporates the Helix spiral element, light/dark, vector + all OS export sizes; and the footer slogan **"Made with ♥ by Helix Development"**.

3. **Theming / white-labeling** per account (Root-configurable colors, logo, slogan).
4. **Wireframes** (Markdown + Mermaid) for the Web portal, CLI/TUI, and mobile.
5. **UX flow diagrams** for the key journeys: add channel, process post, search, manage account.
6. The **reusable component library**.
7. **Prototype plans** — interactive + non-interactive (Figma + PenPot + Lottie exports).

The area is **Phase 3 (Client Applications)** in the four-phase plan, and — per the operator's **Web + CLI first** decision `[OPERATOR]` — the Angular 19 web portal and the CLI/TUI surfaces are specified to implementation depth first; Desktop (Tauri), and the four mobile platforms are specified to design depth with their scaffold gaps tracked.

Files in this area

File	Purpose
design-system.md	Token architecture (core + Thready theme), platform fan-out, typography, spacing, motion, a11y contract, visual-regression testing
brand-assets.md	Launcher icon spec (spiral/Helix element, no letters), light/dark, vector + OS export size matrix; Helix Development org logo; the "Made with ♥" footer slogan
theming.md	Light/dark resolution (3 sanctioned mechanisms), per-account white-labeling model, DDL for `account_branding`, runtime CSS-var injection, brand-on-generated-documents
wireframes.md	Screen inventory + wireframes for Web portal, CLI/TUI, and mobile, each as Mermaid + prose
ux-flows.md	The four key journeys as flow/sequence diagrams with states, errors, and event hooks
component-library.md	The `.ds-*` component catalogue, per-platform adapters, props/anatomy/states, and the build-order backlog
prototypes.md	Figma authoring plan, interactive vs. non-interactive prototypes, transition/motion spec, and the export pipeline (Figma/PenPot/PDF/PNG/SVG/Lottie)

Upstream / Downstream dependencies

Upstream (this area consumes / must not contradict):

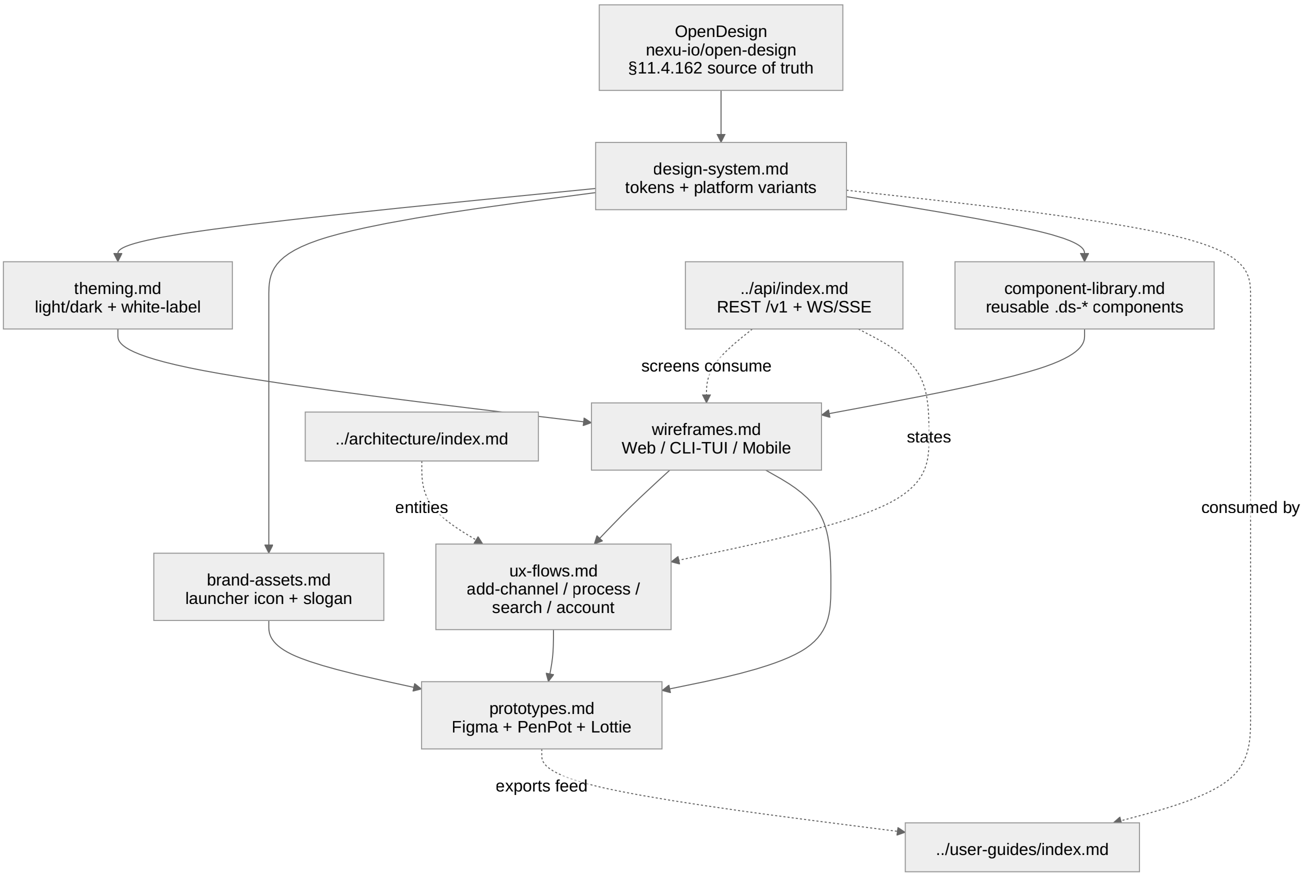
- `docs/private/research/mvp/helix_thready_research_request_final.md` — decision matrix (`design system source = OpenDesign`, `Frontend = Angular 19/22 on design_system`, `Desktop = Tauri 2`, `Mobile = native+KMP`, `TUI = Bubble Tea + Lipgloss`), operator decisions (Web+CLI first, aggressive SLO), Q17–Q20, Q26, §8.3 white-labeling.

- `docs/private/research/mvp/helix_thready_subsystem_gaps_and_improvements.md` — the design-arm gaps (`design_system` foundation, `helix_design` / `helix_ui` scaffolds, KMP UI scaffolds, VisualRegression family no-CI). Every one is addressed below or tracked.
- In-house **`vasic-digital/design_system`** — the real token/component/adapter source (read at source via `gh`; interfaces reproduced verbatim where load-bearing).
- **`nexu-io/open-design`** — the design-system generation daemon `[CONSTITUTION §11.4.162]`.
- ../architecture/index.md — entities (accounts, channels, posts, assets, processing state) and event model that the screens and flows visualize.
- ../api/index.md — the REST `/v1` + WebSocket/SSE contract every screen binds to; UX flows reference specific endpoints/events.

Downstream (consumes this area):

- ../user-guides/index.md — screenshots, illustrations and the component vocabulary used in manuals and tutorials.
- ../testing/index.md — UI/UX test types, visual-regression banks, a11y gates derive from the component states and flow acceptance criteria specified here.
- The implementation repos (Angular web/desktop clients, native mobile clients, TUI) consume the tokens, components and flows verbatim.

Area dependency map



> Rendered PNG/SVG exported via Docs Chain (§11.4.65). Source: `diagrams/design-area-map.mmd`.

Explanation (for readers/models that cannot see the diagram). OpenDesign is the upstream source of truth for the whole area; it (and the shared `design_system` extracted from it) feeds `design-system.md`, which defines the token architecture. From the design system three siblings branch: `theming.md` (light/dark + per-account white-labeling), `brand-assets.md` (the launcher icon and the “Made with ♥” slogan), and `component-library.md` (the reusable `.ds-*` components). Theming and the component library together feed `wireframes.md` (the concrete screens for Web, CLI/TUI and Mobile). Wireframes feed `ux-flows.md` (the four key journeys) and, together with the brand assets, feed `prototypes.md` (the Figma/PenPot/Lottie deliverables). The dotted edges show the cross-area couplings: the API area supplies the endpoints and events that the wireframes render and the flows drive; the architecture area supplies the entities the flows manipulate; and downstream, the design system and the prototype exports are consumed by the user-guides area.

Sources of truth

Source	Used for	Confidence
`vasic-digital/design_system` (`tokens/`, `components/`, `docs/THEMES.md`)	Real token values, `.ds-*` components, Angular `ThemeService` / `I18nService` / `FooterComponent`, WCAG evidence	VERIFIED (read at source via `gh`)
`assets/Logo.png`	Thready brand mark + theme derivation, launcher-icon element	VERIFIED (inspected)
`helix_track/web_client/open-design.config.json`	Product-client OpenDesign config precedent (`primary #BCE63B`, `secondary #7AA590`)	VERIFIED (local clone)
`nexu-io/open-design` (`apps/daemon/src/brands/engine/export.ts`, README)	OpenDesign export surface (tokens.json / theme.json / CSS / PPTX / PDF); release 0.13.0	VERIFIED (read at source)
Decision matrix §0.2, Q17–Q20, Q26; §8.3	Framework choices, design-tool choices, white-labeling	AUTHORITATIVE

Verified vs. assumption ledger

- **VERIFIED:** The `design_system` token names, exact hex values, `.ds-*` component classes, and the Angular adapters (`ThemeService`, `I18nService`, `ThemeToggleComponent`, `LanguagePickerComponent`, `FooterComponent`, `DS_CONFIG` / `DS_LOCALES` / `DS_DICTIONARY`) are reproduced from source — **re-verified at source via `gh` in Pass 3**. The helix-green brand `#B6E376`, light accent `#446E12` (6.03:1 on white), and dark accent `#B6E376` (13.56:1 on `#020817`) are measured, not invented; the two sibling shipped themes (`vasic-red` accent 6.47/7.23, `helix-ota-blue`) are likewise measured. The footer heart is tinted with the verified `--accent-ink` token via the localized `footer.made` / `a11y.love` / `footer.by` keys. The **TUI** Bubble Tea/Lipgloss pattern and its keymap are verified against real source (`helix_track/llms_verifier/…/tui`).
- **ASSUMPTION / `[DEFAULT — adjustable]`:** The exact launcher-icon geometry (now pinned to a numeric spec in brand-assets §3.1 but pending the OpenDesign authoring pass), motion durations beyond the two shipped tokens, the Thready composite public API names, and every wireframe layout are proposed defaults pending operator/team review. (The **Thready secondary teal** is no longer an assumption — it is now the eyedrop-captured `#ABDDC9`, see THREADY-DES-01 below.)
- **SCAFFOLD (do not claim it works):** `helix_design` (non-web design arm) and `helix_ui` (Flutter) are scaffolds; `UI-Components-KMP` and the KMP fleet have no CI/publish; the VisualRegression family has no CI. These are tracked below and in the relevant files.

Gap/register items owned by this area

Each is addressed with a design plan and/or a tracked workable item in the linked file.

Gap (register id)	Status	Where addressed
`[GAP: 8.1 design_system]` foundation, web-only, needs Thready theme + npm publish	FOUNDATION	design-system.md, theming.md, brand-assets.md
`[GAP: 8.2 helix_design]` non-web token packages don't exist (Flutter/Qt/CSS)	SCAFFOLD	design-system.md
`[GAP: 8.3 helix_ui]` Flutter UI scaffold; cannot target HarmonyOS/Aurora	SCAFFOLD	design-system.md, component-library.md
`[GAP: 8.4 UI-Components-KMP]` KMP UI scaffold, no CI/publish	SCAFFOLD	component-library.md
`[GAP: 8.5 helix_shims / HarmonyOS+Aurora clients]` native clients skeleton	SCAFFOLD	wireframes.md, component-library.md
`[GAP: 8.6 TS libs / helix_track_cli]` re-audit before adoption	SCAFFOLD/ FLAGGED	component-library.md
`[GAP: 9.3 VisualRegression family]` Panoptic/ScreenDiff/ReplayBuffer no CI + Thready `challenges` banks	FOUNDATION	design-system.md, component-library.md
`[GAP: 7.3 Security-KMP]` mobile secure storage stub (gates mobile release)	SCAFFOLD	wireframes.md (release gate note)

Workable-items registry

The concrete build/hardening tasks this area defines, consolidated (they were previously only inline in each file). Each closes one or more gap-register items and is ordered by the **Web + CLI first** priority `[OPERATOR]`. IDs are stable and referenced verbatim by the owning files.

Workable item	What it delivers	Closes	Defined in
THREADY-DES-DS-01	Add `tokens/themes/thready.css` + Thready `DS_CONFIG` upstream; publish `@vasic-digital/design-system` to npm; mature the standalone package	`[GAP: 8.1]`	design-system §9, theming §11, brand-assets §11
THREADY-DES-WEB-01	Angular composite set (§5) on the published primitives (git dep until npm)	`[GAP: 8.1]`	component-library §10
THREADY-DES-TUI-01	Lipgloss component styles from the token export (verified pattern)	— (pattern verified)	component-library §10
THREADY-DES-VR-01	CI for the visual-regression family (`ScreenDiff` / `VisualRegression` / `ReplayBuffer`) + wire the theme×state bank	`[GAP: 9.3]` (half 1)	design-system §9, component-library §10, prototypes §11
THREADY-DES-CHAL-01	Thready UI/UX **Challenges** scenario banks (mandated test type)	`[GAP: 9.3]` (half 2)	design-system §9, component-library §9
THREADY-DES-KMP-01	`UI-Components-KMP` CI + Maven publish + token-bridge codegen	`[GAP: 8.4]`	design-system §9, component-library §10
THREADY-DES-FLUT-01 / -QT-01	`helix_design` per-platform token packages (Flutter, Qt/Aurora); native ArkTS/Qt via `helix_shims`	`[GAP: 8.2/8.3/8.5]`	design-system §9, component-library §10
THREADY-DES-REACT-01	`UI-Components-React` re-audit + adoption (only if a React surface is needed)	`[GAP: 8.6]`	component-library §10
THREADY-DES-EXPORT-01	Build/validate the **PenPot** + **Lottie** export bridges (not native OpenDesign targets)	`[OPEN: THREADY-DES-02]`	prototypes §11

Open items

The full, canonical open-item list for this area (`THREADY-DES-01…-14`). Each is tracked in its owning file; this table is the single place to see them all and their state.

ID	State	Summary	Owning file(s)
THREADY-DES-01	`CLOSED`	`--brand-2` teal captured via formal `Logo.png` eyedrop (`#ABDDC9` light / `#B7EBD6` dark), replacing the `#7AA590` stand-in	design-system §3.2, brand-assets §11
THREADY-DES-02	`OPEN`	PenPot + Lottie are **not** native OpenDesign export targets — bridges must be built (`THREADY-DES-EXPORT-01`)	prototypes.md, design-system §10
THREADY-DES-03	`OPEN`	Heart-glyph "proper color": brand accent-ink (current default) vs. classic love-red	brand-assets §8, design-system §3.2
THREADY-DES-04	`OPEN`	Verify Cyrillic subsets of the three variable faces for ru / sr-Cyrl	design-system §4, component-library §11, prototypes §11
THREADY-DES-05	`OPEN` `[RESEARCH]`	Aurora density buckets (86/108/128/172/250) must be verified against current Aurora OS packaging docs	brand-assets §5.1
THREADY-DES-06	`OPEN`	Whether Account Admins (tier 2), not only Root, may edit their own Account branding	theming §11, ux-flows §5
THREADY-DES-07	`OPEN`	Advanced neutral-surface override (beyond accent) needs a full AA re-validation matrix before exposure	theming §11
THREADY-DES-08	`OPEN`	Confirm whether Desktop (Tauri) needs any native screen beyond the wrapped web UI (tray/notifications)	wireframes §7
THREADY-DES-09	`OPEN`	High-fidelity Figma frames for every wireframe screen (produced in prototypes; wireframes are the structural contract)	wireframes §7, prototypes.md
THREADY-DES-10	`OPEN`	Finalize endpoint/event names with the API area (UX-flow names are	ux-flows §7

ID	State	Summary	Owning file(s)
		`[DEFAULT — adjustable]`)	
THREADY-DES-11	`OPEN`	Finalize Thready composite public API names with the web implementation team	component-library §11
THREADY-DES-12	`OPEN`	Decide which composites are generic enough to contribute upstream to `design_system` vs. keep in Thready	component-library §11
THREADY-DES-13	`OPEN`	Decide PenPot's role: mirror of Figma (portability only) vs. a co-equal editing surface	prototypes §11
THREADY-DES-14	`OPEN`	Branding model reconciliation (storage **and** contract) with the canonical database + API areas	theming §5/§7/§11, below

Detail on the two highest-impact opens:

- `[CLOSED: THREADY-DES-01]` Formal eyedrop mean of `assets/Logo.png` captured (pixel-mean per the `design_system` provenance rule §11.4.6): the Thready secondary/teal `--brand-2` = **`#ABDDC9`** (light, mean of n=618,886 mint-region pixels) / `#B7EBD6` (dark, median), replacing the provisional `#7AA590` stand-in. The green-region eyedrop (`#BAE448` , n≈1.06M) corroborates the documented helix-green base, validating the method. Re-confirm with the design-system's own eyedrop tool at integration. Method: design-system §3.2.
- `[OPEN: THREADY-DES-14]` Branding model reconciliation (storage **and** contract). **Storage:** the authoritative database area models branding as `accounts.branding` **JSONB** (`{colors, logo_url, slogan}`), while theming.md §5 proposes a normalized, AA-audited `account_branding` table — reconcile with ../database/index.md. **Contract:** `api/openapi.yaml` already defines `setBranding` with a minimal `Branding` (`primary_color/logo_asset_id/slogan`), while theming.md §7 proposes an expanded contract (typed light/dark accents
  - `422` AA gate) — merge into ../api/index.md, do not maintain in parallel. The design area MUST NOT diverge from the canonical schema/contract.

Conventions applied

Every file in this area carries the mandatory metadata header, a revision-history table, a ToC, inline provenance tags (`[CONSTITUTION §x]` , `[IN-HOUSE: module]` , `[RESEARCH]` , `[OPERATOR]` , `[DEFAULT — adjustable]` , `[BUILD-NEW]` , `[GAP: id]` , `[OPEN: id]`), and — for every Mermaid diagram — a multi-paragraph prose explanation plus a sibling `diagrams/<name>.mmd` source `[CONVENTIONS §4]`. Code examples are given in CSS / TypeScript / Go / SQL / YAML.

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